

03 Assignment 1: Evaluating DevOps-Centered Organizations

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Direction

Evaluate each DevOps-centered organization and answer the corresponding question. (3 items × 5 points)

Question 1: How did Target use their *People*, a DevOps element, to drive change to their culture?

Target transformed its culture through bottom-up leadership and community building rather than top-down mandates:

- **Internal Evangelism:** Champions like technical architect Dan Cundiff demonstrated the practical value of DevOps by successfully launching apps like *Cartwheel*.
 - **Internal DevOpsDays:** Target hosted internal events with open labs, demos, and lightning talks to break down silos and encourage learning between development and operations teams.
 - **External Community Meetups:** Sponsoring Minneapolis DevOpsDays events allowed their engineers to connect with the broader tech community and bring fresh practices back into the company.
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Question 2: Would you say that Adobe used the *Lean* principle? If not, which principle did they employ?

Yes, Adobe used the Lean principle.

- **Reducing Batch Size & Waste:** Moving to a cloud services model required shifting from large, semi-annual releases to continuous small updates. This reduced deployment risks, cut down on rework, and allowed Adobe to meet 60% more app development demand.
 - **Supporting Principle (Automation):** To enable these continuous releases, Adobe used CloudMunch to automate and manage their deployment pipelines with multi-project visibility.
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Question 3: Based on Fidelity Worldwide Investment's problem, which DevOps Principle did they consider using to solve it? Would any of the ITIL Principles do the same?

- **DevOps Principle (Automation):** Fidelity used **Automation** to solve their deployment problems. By replacing slow, manual deployments across hundreds of servers with an automated release framework, they cut release times from 2–3 days down to 1–2 hours, avoided costly errors, and saved over \$2.3 million annually.
- **Equivalent ITIL Principle (Optimize and Automate):** The ITIL principle **Optimize and Automate** achieves the exact same goal. It focuses on streamlining repetitive manual workflows and automating them to eliminate human errors, ensure consistency, and speed up delivery.